Reading Language Arts · Practice Test 3

Read each passage, then answer the questions that follow. Use evidence from the texts.

Passage 1 — The First Catch (literary nonfiction)

(1) I was nine the summer my grandfather taught me to fish. Every morning we rowed to the middle of the gray lake and waited. And waited. For three days I caught nothing but boredom.

(2) "Fishing isn't about catching," Grandpa said on the fourth morning, reeling in another empty line. "It's about paying attention."

(3) I didn't understand him. I wanted a fish—something to hold up and photograph. But I kept casting, because he kept casting.

(4) On the fifth day, my line went tight. My heart leaped. I pulled too hard, and the fish slipped free. I groaned, but Grandpa only smiled. "Now you're paying attention," he said.

(5) The next cast, I waited. I felt the smallest tug, counted to three, and lifted gently. A silver fish broke the surface, flashing in the sun. I had done it.

(6) Years later, I still remember what the lake taught me that summer. Patience, it turns out, is its own kind of catch.

1. In paragraph 1, "nothing but boredom" suggests the narrator felt — A. excited B. impatient and bored C. afraid D. proud

2. The narrator keeps casting mainly because — A. he already loves fishing B. his grandfather keeps casting C. he is forced to D. he wants to row the boat

3. When Grandpa says "Now you're paying attention," he means the narrator — A. caught a fish B. is finally focused and learning C. should go home D. is tired

4. The central lesson of the memoir is that — A. fishing is boring B. patience is valuable C. grandfathers are wise D. lakes are gray

5. The author wrote this mainly to — A. inform about fish species B. share a meaningful personal experience and its lesson C. sell fishing gear D. argue a point

6. Which line **best** shows that the narrator learned patience? A. "I wanted a fish" B. "I pulled too hard, and the fish slipped free" C. "The next cast, I waited... and lifted gently" D. "we rowed to the middle"

7. "Patience... is its own kind of catch" is an example of — A. simile B. metaphor C. alliteration D. onomatopoeia

SCR 1. *(2 points)* What does the narrator learn by the end of the memoir? Support your answer with **evidence from the text.**

Passage 2 — Save Our Library (persuasive)

(1) Our school library is more than a room full of books. It is the heart of our school—and it needs our help.

(2) Every day, students visit the library to read, study, and find a quiet place to think. For some, it is the only place they can borrow books they could never afford to buy. Closing it, or cutting its hours, would leave these students behind.

(3) Imagine a school where no one reads for joy, where research means guessing instead of learning. Is that the school we want?

(4) We can act now. Sign the petition, attend the board meeting, and tell the district that our library matters. Together, our voices are loud enough to save it.

(5) Don't wait until the shelves are empty. Stand up for your library today.

8. The author's purpose is to — A. inform about library hours B. persuade readers to support the library C. tell a story D. describe a book

9. The author's main message is that — A. libraries are outdated B. the community should act to save the library C. books are expensive D. students should study more

10. "Is that the school we want?" is a — A. statistic B. rhetorical question meant to persuade C. definition D. stage direction

11. Which detail **best** supports the idea that the library helps students who cannot buy books? A. "a room full of books" B. "the only place they can borrow books they could never afford to buy" C. "attend the board meeting" D. "the heart of our school"

12. "Stand up for your library today" is an example of — A. a call to action B. a counter-argument C. a citation D. a simile

13. The author most likely wrote this because the library is — A. brand new B. at risk of closing or cuts C. too big D. never used

14. Which is the **best** summary? A. The library has books. B. The author urges readers to take action to save a valued school library that some students depend on. C. Board meetings are long. D. Reading is fun.

SCR 2. *(2 points)* Why does the author believe the library is important? Use **evidence from the passage.**

Paired Set — The Old Oak & Why Trees Matter

Text A — "The Old Oak" (poem)

For a hundred years it stood,
arms open to the sky,
shade for the weary traveler,
home where the songbirds fly.
It asked for nothing, gave for free—
the patient, giving tree.

Text B — "Why Trees Matter"

Trees do quiet, important work. They clean the air by taking in carbon dioxide and releasing oxygen. Their roots hold soil in place and soak up rainwater, preventing floods. Their shade cools neighborhoods and lowers energy costs. Protecting old trees protects us, too.

15. In Text A, calling the tree "patient" and "giving" is an example of — A. personification B. simile C. irony D. hyperbole

16. Text A is written in — A. paragraphs B. lines and a stanza with rhyme C. a script D. a chart

17. The main idea of Text B is that trees — A. are pretty B. provide important environmental benefits C. live a long time D. give birds homes

18. Both texts present trees as — A. useless B. valuable and worth protecting C. dangerous D. temporary

19. Which idea appears in Text B but **not** in Text A? A. Trees give shade B. Trees clean the air and prevent floods C. Trees are homes for birds D. Trees are old

20. Text A mainly aims to — A. inform with data B. express appreciation for a tree C. argue for a law D. give directions

Revising — "A Class Trip"

(1) Our class should visit the history museum. (2) The museum has exhibits about our state. (3) We would learn a lot. (4) It is close to our school. (5) Some students have never been. (6) A trip would be fun and educational.

21. Which sentence could **best** be added after sentence 2 to develop it with a detail? A. "Museums are nice." B. "For example, one exhibit shows tools and clothing from a hundred years ago." C. "I like trips." D. "It is a building."

22. Which transition would **best** begin sentence 4? A. However, B. In addition, C. Because D. But

23. What is the **best** way to combine sentences 3 and 4? A. We would learn a lot, it is close. B. We would learn a lot, and the museum is close to our school. C. Learn a lot and close museum. D. A lot of learning, close, museum.

24. Which sentence **best** states the writer's main idea (thesis)? A. Sentence 1 B. Sentence 3 C. Sentence 5 D. Sentence 6

Editing — "My Dog"

(1) My dog Rex run to the door every morning. (2) He wait for me to take him outside. (3) Their is nothing he loves more than a walk. (4) After are walk, he takes a long nap.

25. What change should be made in sentence 1? A. Change "run" to "runs" B. Change "dog" to "dogs" C. Change "every" to "ever" D. No change

26. What change should be made in sentence 2? A. Change "wait" to "waits" B. Change "me" to "I" C. Change "him" to "he" D. No change

27. What change should be made in sentence 3? A. Change "Their" to "There" B. Change "nothing" to "no thing" C. Change "loves" to "love" D. No change

28. What change should be made in sentence 4? A. Change "are" to "our" B. Change "walk" to "walks" C. Change "nap" to "naps" D. No change

Extended Constructed Response (ECR) — *(10 points)*

Passage 2, "Save Our Library," argues that the school library should be saved. **Do you agree that schools should invest in their libraries?** Write a multi-paragraph **argumentative essay** that states your position and supports it with reasons and evidence, including evidence from the passage. Organize your essay with an introduction, body paragraphs, and a conclusion, and use correct grammar and spelling.

Answers and full explanations for this test are in Part 3 · Answer Keys & Explanations.